

ARITHMETIC PREFIXES AND CYCLE-MATROID DEPENDENCE IN A MULTIPLICATIVE PLAQUETTE SHIFT

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ABSTRACT. Let $a, b \geq 2$ be coprime and let $\mathbb{F}_q$ be a finite field. We study the compact linear multiplicative constraint space

$$X_{a,b} = \{x \in \mathbb{F}_q^{\mathbb{N}} : x_n - x_{an} - x_{bn} + x_{abn} = 0 \text{ for every } n \geq 1\}.$$

Every integer has unique coordinates ra^ib^j , and on each root component the rule integrates to $x_{ra^ib^j} = u_i + v_j$. This yields an explicit topological-group isomorphism between $X_{a,b}$ and the unrestricted coordinates whose indices are not divisible by ab . We then calculate every finite projection. A coordinate ra^ib^j is viewed as an edge from row vertex i to column vertex j ; the projection dimension is the sum of the number of vertices minus the number of connected components over the resulting root-wise bipartite graphs. Thus the coordinate-dependence matroid is a direct sum of graphic matroids, and the only finite compatibility conditions are alternating cycle sums. Under Haar measure, forests are exactly the jointly independent coordinate families and each cycle-rank unit contributes $\log q$ of total correlation. Arithmetic prefixes have $q^{N - \lfloor N/(ab) \rfloor}$ patterns, whereas an $M \times N$ exponent rectangle has q^{M+N-1} patterns. These are two normalizations of one finite-shape rank formula, not interchangeable entropy statements.

1. INTRODUCTION

Multiplicative symbolic constraints come with more than one natural finite geometry. Arithmetic prefixes retain the indices $1, \dots, N$, while prime-valuation or exponent coordinates organize a multiplicative orbit into a lattice. Pattern counts in these geometries need not have the same scale. The difference is structural, not a normalization error.

The foundational multiplicative-integer framework and its dimension theory were developed by Kenyon, Peres, and Solomyak [4]. Pattern generation and spatial entropy for multiplicative systems, as well as coupled multidimensional systems, axial products, and surface entropy, are treated in [1–3]. Prime-valuation coordinates also support exact density and correlation constructions, including recent symbolic realizations [5]. Against this established background, we isolate one finite-field linear rule and ask for an exact answer on *every* finite coordinate set.

Fix coprime integers $a, b \geq 2$ and a finite field $\mathbb{F}_q$. On $\mathbb{F}_q^{\mathbb{N}}$ define

$$(1) \quad X_{a,b} = \{x : x_n - x_{an} - x_{bn} + x_{abn} = 0 \text{ for every } n \in \mathbb{N}\}.$$

For $c \in \mathbb{N}$, the decimation $D_c(x)_n = x_{cn}$ preserves $X_{a,b}$, so (1) is a compact linear multiplicative system. The local rule factors into two first differences after multiplicative coordinates are introduced. That elementary observation is only the starting point: the main result identifies the full finite-projection matroid.

Every $n \in \mathbb{N}$ can be written uniquely as

$$n = ra^ib^j, \quad i, j \in \mathbb{N}_0, \quad a \nmid r, \quad b \nmid r.$$

For a finite $F \subset \mathbb{N}$ and a fixed root r , let

$$E_r(F) = \{(i, j) : ra^ib^j \in F\}.$$

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Make a bipartite graph $G_r(F)$ whose row vertices are the i 's occurring in $E_r(F)$, whose column vertices are the j 's occurring there, and whose edges are the pairs in $E_r(F)$. Write $I_r(F)$ and $J_r(F)$ for its two vertex classes and $c_r(F)$ for its number of connected components. Empty graphs are omitted. Define

$$(2) \quad d(F) = \sum_r (|I_r(F)| + |J_r(F)| - c_r(F)),$$

$$(3) \quad \beta(F) = \sum_r (|E_r(F)| - |I_r(F)| - |J_r(F)| + c_r(F)).$$

Thus $d(F) + \beta(F) = |F|$, and $\beta(F)$ is the sum of the graph cycle ranks. For precision, the *coordinate-dependence matroid on F* below is the vector matroid of the evaluation maps

$$\epsilon_n : X_{a,b} \longrightarrow \mathbb{F}_q, \quad \epsilon_n(x) = x_n, \text{quad } n \in F.$$

Thus $A \subseteq F$ is independent when the functionals $\{\epsilon_n : n \in A\}$ are linearly independent. This is the standard linear-dependence meaning of matroid terminology [7].

Theorem 1.1 (Finite-shape structure). *Let $a, b \geq 2$ be coprime and let $\mathbb{F}_q$ be a finite field.*

(1) *Put $\mathcal{B} = \{n \in \mathbb{N} : ab \nmid n\}$. Coordinate restriction is a topological-group isomorphism*

$$X_{a,b} \longrightarrow \mathbb{F}_q^{\mathcal{B}}.$$

Its inverse is explicit: if $n = ra^ib^j$, then

$$(4) \quad x_{ra^ib^j} = x_{ra^i} + x_{rb^j} - x_r.$$

(2) *For every finite $F \subset \mathbb{N}$, the image $\text{proj}_F(X_{a,b})$ is a linear subspace of dimension $d(F)$. Hence*

$$(5) \quad |\text{proj}_F(X_{a,b})| = q^{d(F)}.$$

The coordinate-dependence matroid is the direct sum over r of the graphic matroids of $G_r(F)$. Equivalently, allowed labels are exactly those whose alternating sum vanishes on every graph cycle.

(3) *Let μ be normalized Haar measure on $X_{a,b}$. Then*

$$(6) \quad H_\mu(Z_F) = d(F) \log q, \quad \text{TC}_\mu(Z_F) = \beta(F) \log q, \quad Z_F = (x_n)_{n \in F}.$$

The coordinates in F are jointly independent if and only if every $G_r(F)$ is a forest. In particular, every two distinct coordinates are independent.

The theorem unifies two counts that look incompatible when stated alone.

Corollary 1.2 (Prefixes and exponent rectangles). *For every $L \geq 1$,*

$$(7) \quad |\text{proj}_{\{1, \dots, L\}}(X_{a,b})| = q^{L - \lfloor L/(ab) \rfloor}.$$

For a root r and $M, N \geq 1$, put

$$Q_r(M, N) = \{ra^ib^j : 0 \leq i < M, 0 \leq j < N\}.$$

Then

$$(8) \quad |\text{proj}_{Q_r(M, N)}(X_{a,b})| = q^{M+N-1}, \quad \beta(Q_r(M, N)) = (M-1)(N-1).$$

The first exponent in (7) has positive density in the arithmetic interval. The second is boundary order in the exponent box. We call the former an arithmetic-prefix complexity and the latter an exact exponent-box boundary law. Neither phrase silently selects a Følner sequence or asserts a topological entropy for the multiplicative action.

The proof has three short layers. First, the multiplicative root decomposition turns (1) into a vanishing mixed difference on $\mathbb{N}_0^2$, whose solutions are sums of one row and one column potential. Second, restriction to an arbitrary finite set becomes a vertex-potential map on $G_r(F)$; its rank and its cycle conditions are the standard incidence rank and cycle space. Third, Haar measure pushes forward uniformly to every finite image, converting rank and cycle rank into exact entropy and total correlation.

Organization. [Section 2](#) proves the global coordinates and product homeomorphism. [Section 3](#) proves the all-finite-shape rank, cycle, and Haar statements. [Sections 4](#) and [5](#) specialize the formula to the two geometries. [Section 6](#) records the literature context and the claim boundary.

2. MULTIPLICATIVE COMPONENTS AND GLOBAL COORDINATES

Write

$$\mathcal{R}_{a,b} = \{r \in \mathbb{N} : a \nmid r, b \nmid r\}.$$

The coprimality assumption gives a coordinate system adapted to both multipliers.

Lemma 2.1 (Root decomposition). *The map*

$$\mathcal{R}_{a,b} \times \mathbb{N}_0^2 \longrightarrow \mathbb{N}, \quad (r, i, j) \longmapsto ra^i b^j,$$

is a bijection.

Proof. For $n \in \mathbb{N}$, let i be maximal with $a^i \mid n$ and let j be maximal with $b^j \mid n$. Since a and b are coprime, $a^i b^j \mid n$. The integer $r = n/(a^i b^j)$ is divisible by neither a nor b , by maximality.

Conversely, suppose $n = ra^i b^j$ with $r \in \mathcal{R}_{a,b}$. The factor rb^j is not divisible by a : otherwise $\gcd(a, b^j) = 1$ would imply $a \mid r$. Hence i is the maximal exponent of a power of a dividing n . The same argument identifies j as the maximal b -exponent. Both exponents and then r are unique. $\square$

For $x \in \mathbb{F}_q^{\mathbb{N}}$ and $r \in \mathcal{R}_{a,b}$, set

$$y_{i,j}^{(r)} = x_{ra^i b^j}, \quad (i, j) \in \mathbb{N}_0^2.$$

The equation defining $X_{a,b}$ becomes

$$(9) \quad y_{i,j} - y_{i+1,j} - y_{i,j+1} + y_{i+1,j+1} = 0.$$

We omit the root superscript while studying one component.

Lemma 2.2 (Integration of the plaquette rule). *An array $y \in \mathbb{F}_q^{\mathbb{N}_0^2}$ satisfies (9) for all $i, j \geq 0$ if and only if*

$$(10) \quad y_{i,j} = y_{i,0} + y_{0,j} - y_{0,0} \quad (i, j \geq 0).$$

Equivalently, after the gauge choice $v_0 = 0$, it has the unique form

$$(11) \quad y_{i,j} = u_i + v_j, \quad u_i = y_{i,0}, \quad v_j = y_{0,j} - y_{0,0}.$$

Proof. Rearranging (9) gives

$$y_{i+1,j+1} - y_{i,j+1} = y_{i+1,j} - y_{i,j}.$$

Thus the horizontal increment from row i to row $i+1$ is independent of the column. Summing these increments from 0 to $i-1$ yields $y_{i,j} - y_{0,j} = y_{i,0} - y_{0,0}$, which is (10). Direct substitution proves the converse. The gauge formula (11) follows immediately and remains valid in characteristic two. $\square$

The component solution group is therefore explicitly isomorphic to

$$\mathcal{Y} \cong \mathbb{F}_q^{\mathbb{N}_0} \times \mathbb{F}_q^{\mathbb{N}},$$

where the two factors record the full row axis and the positive column axis. The next proposition identifies these axes directly in the arithmetic index set.

Proposition 2.3 (Global free-axis coordinates). *Let*

$$\mathcal{B} = \{n \in \mathbb{N} : ab \nmid n\}.$$

The restriction map

$$(12) \quad \rho_{\mathcal{B}} : X_{a,b} \longrightarrow \mathbb{F}_q^{\mathcal{B}}, \quad x \longmapsto x|_{\mathcal{B}},$$

is a topological-group isomorphism. If $n = ra^ib^j$ is its root representation, the inverse map is

$$(13) \quad (\rho_{\mathcal{B}}^{-1}z)_{ra^ib^j} = z_{ra^i} + z_{rb^j} - z_r.$$

Consequently,

$$(14) \quad X_{a,b} \cong \prod_{r \in \mathcal{R}_{a,b}} \mathcal{Y} \cong \mathbb{F}_q^{\mathcal{B}}.$$

Proof. For $n = ra^ib^j$, the product ab divides n exactly when $i, j \geq 1$. The forward implication uses coprimality: if $i = 0$ and $a \mid rb^j$, then $a \mid r$, contrary to $r \in \mathcal{R}_{a,b}$; the case $j = 0$ is symmetric. Thus $\mathcal{B}$ is precisely the union of the two axes in every root component, with the origin counted once.

By Lemma 2.2, those axes determine every point of $X_{a,b}$, so (12) is injective. Conversely, for arbitrary $z \in \mathbb{F}_q^{\mathcal{B}}$, formula (13) is defined because all three indices on its right lie in $\mathcal{B}$. It agrees with z on either axis and satisfies every plaquette equation by Lemma 2.2. Hence restriction is surjective.

Both maps are homomorphisms. Restriction is continuous, and each coordinate of its inverse depends on only three coordinates of z . The inverse is therefore continuous in the product topology. The component product description follows from Lemmas 2.1 and 2.2. $\square$

Remark 2.4 (Why coprimality is structural). The proof uses $\gcd(a, b) = 1$ twice: to split divisibility exponents and to identify the free axes with $ab \nmid n$. When the multipliers share a factor, the exponent coordinates can have multiple presentations, so Proposition 2.3 is not asserted.

3. FINITE PROJECTIONS AND GRAPHIC MATROIDS

The product homeomorphism solves global extension, but it does not by itself display the dependence among an arbitrary selection of non-axis coordinates. The right finite object is the bipartite graph introduced before Theorem 1.1.

Fix a finite $F \subset \mathbb{N}$. For each root r occurring in F , write

$$E_r = E_r(F), \quad I_r = I_r(F), \quad J_r = J_r(F), \quad G_r = G_r(F).$$

Regard I_r and J_r as disjoint vertex classes even if the same integer appears in both. Define the vertex-potential map

$$(15) \quad \Phi_r : \mathbb{F}_q^{I_r} \oplus \mathbb{F}_q^{J_r} \longrightarrow \mathbb{F}_q^{E_r}, \quad \Phi_r(u, v)_{(i,j)} = u_i + v_j.$$

Lemma 3.1 (Potential rank). *The image of Φ_r is exactly the restriction to E_r of all global solutions of (9), and*

$$(16) \quad \text{rank } \Phi_r = |I_r| + |J_r| - c_r.$$

Proof. Every global component solution has the potential form (11), so its restriction lies in $\text{im } \Phi_r$. Conversely, potentials on the used vertices extend to all row and column indices by assigning arbitrary values to unused vertices. Formula (11) then gives a global solution with the prescribed edge labels. This proves the image statement.

On one connected component of G_r , a kernel vector satisfies $u_i = -v_j$ on every edge. Connectivity forces all row potentials to equal one scalar t and all column potentials to equal $-t$. Each component therefore contributes one kernel dimension. Rank-nullity proves (16). $\square$

Distinct root components use disjoint potential variables. Adding the ranks in Lemma 3.1 proves the dimension and count in Theorem 1.1. We record the complete compatibility description because it also identifies the matroid.

Orient every edge of G_r from its row endpoint to its column endpoint and replace v_j by $-w_j$. Then

$$\Phi_r(u, v)_{(i,j)} = u_i - w_j,$$

so, up to a sign change on one vertex class, Φ_r is the graph coboundary map. Write a simple graph cycle as

$$(17) \quad (i_1, j_1), (i_2, j_1), (i_2, j_2), \dots, (i_k, j_k), (i_1, j_k)$$

Its alternating edge sum is

$$(18) \quad z_{i_1, j_1} - z_{i_2, j_1} + z_{i_2, j_2} - \dots - z_{i_1, j_k} = 0.$$

In characteristic two all signs coincide, and the equation is unchanged as a field identity.

Proposition 3.2 (Cycle equations are complete). *An edge labelling $z \in \mathbb{F}_q^{E_r}$ lies in $\text{im } \Phi_r$ if and only if (18) holds for every simple cycle of G_r . It suffices to check the fundamental cycles relative to any spanning forest.*

Proof. For a potential labelling, the alternating sum telescopes, proving necessity. For sufficiency, choose a spanning forest and one base vertex in each component. Assign potential zero at each base vertex and integrate the edge labels along the unique forest paths. A nonforest edge closes a fundamental cycle. Its cycle equation says exactly that the two integrated endpoint potentials reproduce its label. Hence the constructed potentials reproduce all edge labels. $\square$

Corollary 3.3 (Graphic coordinate matroid). *The vector matroid of the restricted evaluation maps $\{\epsilon_n : n \in F\}$ is*

$$(19) \quad \bigoplus_r M(G_r(F)),$$

the direct sum of the graphic matroids of the root-wise incidence graphs. In particular, a subset of coordinates is linearly independent exactly when its root-wise edge sets are forests. Moreover,

$$(20) \quad \dim \text{proj}_F(X_{a,b}) = d(F), \quad \text{codim } \text{proj}_F(X_{a,b}) = \beta(F).$$

Proof. With potentials as columns and edge values as rows, the rows of the matrix in (15) represent the evaluation maps ϵ_n on the finite potential space. After the column-vertex sign change, those rows are the columns of an oriented vertex-edge incidence matrix after transposition. Its column matroid is the graphic matroid [7]. This representation remains valid in characteristic two, where the two incidence signs coincide. Roots give block-diagonal matrices and hence the direct sum. A graphic-matroid basis is a maximal spanning forest, and the codimension identity is the Euler formula $|E| - |V| + c$ summed over roots. $\square$

We next convert this rank statement into an exact dependence statement. Let μ be normalized Haar measure on the compact abelian group $X_{a,b}$. For a finite random vector $Z_F = (x_n)_{n \in F}$, define its total correlation in the standard multivariate-information sense [6] by

$$(21) \quad \text{TC}_\mu(Z_F) = \sum_{n \in F} H_\mu(x_n) - H_\mu(Z_F),$$

with natural logarithms.

Proposition 3.4 (Haar forest independence). *For every finite $F \subset \mathbb{N}$, the Haar projection to F is uniform on $\text{proj}_F(X_{a,b})$ and*

$$(22) \quad H_\mu(Z_F) = d(F) \log q, \quad \text{TC}_\mu(Z_F) = \beta(F) \log q.$$

The coordinates in F are jointly independent if and only if every $G_r(F)$ is a forest. Every pair of distinct coordinates is independent.

Proof. The projection from $X_{a,b}$ onto its finite image is a continuous surjective group homomorphism. It sends Haar measure to Haar measure on the finite image, which is normalized counting measure. The joint entropy is therefore the logarithm of the image size, namely $d(F) \log q$.

Each single coordinate projection is all of $\mathbb{F}_q$, so every marginal entropy is $\log q$. Subtracting the joint entropy and using $|F| - d(F) = \beta(F)$ proves (22). Joint independence is equivalent to

equality between joint entropy and the sum of marginal entropies, hence to $\beta(F) = 0$, which is exactly the forest condition. Finally, two distinct arithmetic coordinates produce two distinct edges in simple bipartite graphs, possibly in different root components. Two such edges form a forest. $\square$

Example 3.5 (Pairwise independence with a four-way relation). For

$$F = \{r, ra, rb, rab\},$$

the graph is $K_{2,2}$. Every proper edge subset is a forest, but the four coordinates obey

$$x_r - x_{ra} - x_{rb} + x_{rab} = 0.$$

Thus the four coordinates have joint entropy $3 \log q$ and total correlation $\log q$, although every distinct pair is independent. Larger finite shapes replace this single plaquette by a cycle basis; no compatibility outside the finite incidence graph is hidden in the global extension problem.

4. ARITHMETIC PREFIXES

Let $[L] = \{1, \dots, L\}$. The global free-axis coordinates immediately give the exact prefix law, including extension to a full point.

Proposition 4.1 (Exact prefix count). *For every $L \geq 1$,*

$$(23) \quad \left| \text{proj}_{[L]}(X_{a,b}) \right| = q^{L - \lfloor L/(ab) \rfloor}.$$

Equivalently,

$$(24) \quad \dim_{\mathbb{F}_q} \text{proj}_{[L]}(X_{a,b}) = L - \left\lfloor \frac{L}{ab} \right\rfloor.$$

Proof. The free indices in the prefix are

$$\mathcal{B} \cap [L] = \{n \leq L : ab \nmid n\},$$

whose cardinality is $L - \lfloor L/(ab) \rfloor$. Every coordinate at most L is determined by these free values: if $n = ra^i b^j \leq L$, then the three indices ra^i , rb^j , and r in (13) are all at most n .

Conversely, every assignment on $\mathcal{B} \cap [L]$ occurs in a global point. Extend it arbitrarily, for example by zero, to all of $\mathcal{B}$ and apply Proposition 2.3. Restriction from the prefix pattern set to $\mathcal{B} \cap [L]$ is therefore a bijection. Counting its assignments proves (23). $\square$

There is also an independent check of the rank of the internally visible constraint matrix. The identification of its kernel with the actual prefix projection still uses the global extension established in Proposition 2.3; the pivot computation below is not, by itself, an extension theorem. The constraints visible inside $[L]$ are indexed by $1 \leq n \leq \lfloor L/(ab) \rfloor$. Each has the form

$$(25) \quad x_n - x_{an} - x_{bn} + x_{abn} = 0.$$

Lemma 4.2 (Triangular prefix pivots). *The rows (25), for $n \leq \lfloor L/(ab) \rfloor$, are linearly independent over every field. Their rank is $\lfloor L/(ab) \rfloor$.*

Proof. Suppose that a nontrivial linear combination vanishes and choose the largest index n with nonzero row coefficient. The coordinate abn appears in the row indexed by n with coefficient one. If it appears in another row indexed by m , then one of

$$m = abn, \quad am = abn, \quad bm = abn, \quad abm = abn$$

holds. Apart from $m = n$ in the last equality, each possible m is larger than n . All such row coefficients vanish by maximality. The coefficient of x_{abn} in the linear combination is therefore the nonzero coefficient of the n th row, a contradiction. $\square$

The pivot proof shows that the local constraint matrix has exactly one independent row for each multiple of ab . Together with the extension and dimension results in [Propositions 2.3](#) and [4.1](#), this confirms that there are no further prefix relations. In the graph language it gives the identity

$$(26) \quad \beta([L]) = \left\lfloor \frac{L}{ab} \right\rfloor.$$

Thus the same number is the codimension of the prefix projection and the total root-wise cycle rank of its incidence graphs.

Definition 4.3 (Arithmetic-prefix complexity). Define

$$h_{\text{pref}}(X_{a,b}) = \lim_{L \rightarrow \infty} \frac{1}{L} \log |\text{proj}_{[L]}(X_{a,b})|.$$

Corollary 4.4. *The limit in [Definition 4.3](#) exists and equals*

$$(27) \quad h_{\text{pref}}(X_{a,b}) = \left(1 - \frac{1}{ab}\right) \log q.$$

Proof. Divide [\(23\)](#) by L on the logarithmic scale and let $L \rightarrow \infty$. $\square$

Remark 4.5 (Terminology firewall). The sets $[L]$ are arithmetic intervals, not a declared Følner sequence for the multiplicative semigroup acting by decimations. Accordingly, [\(27\)](#) is a prefix pattern-growth invariant. No topological or measure entropy for a multiplicative action is inferred from it.

5. EXPONENT RECTANGLES AND BOUNDARY LAWS

Arithmetic prefixes intersect many root components irregularly. An exponent rectangle instead stays inside one component and retains a Cartesian set of valuation coordinates. Fix $r \in \mathcal{R}_{a,b}$ and define

$$(28) \quad Q_r(M, N) = \{ra^i b^j : 0 \leq i < M, 0 \leq j < N\}, \quad M, N \geq 1.$$

Proposition 5.1 (Exact exponent-box law). *For every $M, N \geq 1$,*

$$(29) \quad \dim \text{proj}_{Q_r(M,N)}(X_{a,b}) = M + N - 1,$$

$$(30) \quad |\text{proj}_{Q_r(M,N)}(X_{a,b})| = q^{M+N-1},$$

$$(31) \quad \beta(Q_r(M, N)) = (M - 1)(N - 1).$$

Under normalized Haar measure,

$$(32) \quad H_\mu(x_{Q_r(M,N)}) = (M + N - 1) \log q, \quad \text{TC}_\mu(x_{Q_r(M,N)}) = (M - 1)(N - 1) \log q.$$

Proof. The graph $G_r(Q_r(M, N))$ contains all edges between its M row vertices and N column vertices. It is the connected complete bipartite graph $K_{M,N}$. Its graphic rank is $M + N - 1$, while its cycle rank is

$$MN - (M + N) + 1 = (M - 1)(N - 1).$$

Apply [Corollary 3.3](#) and [proposition 3.4](#). $\square$

The pattern exponent has boundary rather than area order:

$$(33) \quad \frac{1}{MN} \log |\text{proj}_{Q_r(M,N)}(X_{a,b})| = \frac{M + N - 1}{MN} \log q.$$

In particular, [\(33\)](#) tends to zero whenever both M and N diverge. This vanishing reflects the factorization into row and column potentials. It does not contradict the positive arithmetic-prefix rate in [\(27\)](#); the two sequences sample different portions of the product coordinates.

Corollary 5.2 (Rectangles on distinct roots). *Let $r_1, \dots, r_s$ be distinct roots and let*

$$F = \bigsqcup_{t=1}^s Q_{r_t}(M_t, N_t).$$

Then

$$\dim \text{proj}_F(X_{a,b}) = \sum_{t=1}^s (M_t + N_t - 1), \quad \beta(F) = \sum_{t=1}^s (M_t - 1)(N_t - 1).$$

The corresponding Haar random vectors are independent across the roots.

Proof. Distinct roots belong to distinct factors in the product (14). Their incidence matrices and finite Haar images form direct products, so dimensions, cycle ranks, and entropies add. $\square$

The same calculation applies to nonrectangular shapes without new extension arguments. If an edge lies on a cycle, deleting it preserves the projection dimension and decreases the cycle defect by one. If the edge is a bridge, deleting it decreases the projection dimension by one and preserves the cycle defect. Dually, adding an edge raises the dimension when it joins different components (or introduces a new vertex), whereas adding it within one connected component closes a cycle, leaves the dimension fixed, and raises the cycle defect by one. Thus the arbitrary-shape theorem records more than the number of rows and columns: it tracks precisely which missing cells destroy which dependencies.

TABLE 1. Three finite geometries governed by the same graph-rank formula. The last column records the normalization used in this paper, not a universal dynamical entropy.

Finite set	Incidence graph	Projection dimension	Cycle defect	Reading
arbitrary F	root-wise $G_r(F)$	$\sum_r (V_r - c_r)$	$\sum_r \beta_1(G_r)$	exact finite-shape rank
prefix $[L]$	irregular union over roots	$L - \lfloor L/(ab) \rfloor$	$\lfloor L/(ab) \rfloor$	divide log count by L
rectangle $Q_r(M, N)$	$K_{M,N}$	$M + N - 1$	$(M - 1)(N - 1)$	area- normalized rate tends to zero

6. COMPARISON, SCOPE, AND CONTROLS

The finite-shape theorem sits at the intersection of several established frameworks, so its claim boundary matters as much as its calculation.

Multiplicative symbolic systems. Kenyon, Peres, and Solomyak established a foundational setting for symbolic spaces invariant under multiplication and developed dimension formulas and a variational principle [4]. Ban, Hu, and Lin subsequently studied pattern generation, spatial entropy, and Minkowski dimensions for multiplicative systems [1]. These works provide the established setting for the present problem. We use that setting, not their dimension or entropy machinery: the finite-field space here is solved by an explicit linear parameterization. **Coupled and axial-product entropy.** Ban, Hu, and Lai study entropy formulas for multidimensional multiplicative integer subshifts with coupling constraints [2]. Ban, Hu, Lai, and Liao calculate entropy and surface entropy for axial products of subshifts and multiplicative subshifts [3]. Those results provide broad entropy and surface-complexity context. Our rectangle formula is called a boundary law only as an exact count; it is not presented as a new general surface-entropy theorem.

Valuation coordinates and correlations. Mora Cuellar, Rojas Aravena, and Yavicoli use prime-valuation coordinates to derive additive and multiplicative density statements, exact finite-coordinate correlations, random models, and symbolic realizations [5]. Their work is the closest current source for valuation-coordinate correlations. The present Haar calculation concerns a different object: a finite-field linear plaquette constraint whose arbitrary coordinate dependence is represented by root-wise graphic matroids.

Standard matroid and information-theoretic ingredients. The linear-dependence language follows Whitney’s matroid framework [7], and total correlation is the multivariate entropy deficit introduced by Watanabe [6]. Incidence matrices representing graphic matroids and the entropy definition are standard ingredients. The identity $y_{i,j} = u_i + v_j$ is likewise an elementary integration of a factorized mixed difference. The paper-specific result is their explicit arithmetic assembly into the all-finite-shape projection and forest/cycle formulas stated here.

Bounded exact-neighbor search. An exact-string and citing-neighborhood search frozen on 25 August 2026 covered the displayed equation, sign and function-notation variants, “multiplicative plaquette,” finite-field linear multiplicative subshifts, the representation $u_i + v_j$, factorized $(1 - u)(1 - v)$ constraints, and graph-rank/matroid/correlation formulations. It recovered the context cluster above but no source stating the same equation together with the global free-axis homeomorphism and the all-finite-shape graphic-matroid theorem. This is recorded only as `BOUNDED_NO_EXACT_COLLISION_LOCATED`. Search vocabulary may differ, folklore may exist, and no worldwide novelty conclusion follows.

TABLE 2. Claim firewall for the present manuscript.

Statement	Status	Reason
$X_{a,b} \cong \mathbb{F}_q^{\{n:ab\}n}$	proved	explicit continuous inverse
every finite projection has the	proved	potential-map rank and spanning-forest
graph-rank and cycle-space description		integration
Haar finite families are independent	proved	uniform finite Haar image and entropy
exactly on forests		equality
prefix complexity is $(1 - 1/(ab)) \log q$	proved	exact arithmetic-prefix count
exponent rectangles have	proved	exact q^{M+N-1} count
area-normalized rate zero		
either rate is a multiplicative Følner	not asserted	no such averaging sequence is selected
entropy		here
Haar measure is mixing or ergodic for	not asserted	finite-coordinate Haar dependence
every decimation action		alone does not prove it
the theorem is the first result of its kind	not claimed	bounded search cannot certify priority

Deterministic controls. The companion standard-library Python program checks root coordinates, global reconstruction, prefix ranks, every subset of [12] in three finite-field/multiplier cases, exponent rectangles through side length six, and exact Haar potential counts in characteristics 2, 3, and 5. These checks exercise composite coprime multipliers and the characteristic-two sign convention. They are regression evidence only; none replaces [Lemma 2.1](#) and [propositions 2.3](#) and [3.2](#).

The structural rank theorem itself works over any field. Finiteness of $\mathbb{F}_q$ enters only when rank is converted into pattern count and Shannon entropy. Extending the arithmetic decomposition to noncoprime multipliers is a separate problem, as is computing a dynamical entropy after choosing a specific multiplicative action and Følner sequence.

7. CONCLUSION

The multiplicative plaquette rule has a global set of free coordinates: on each root component, the two exponent axes determine the entire array, and across all roots these axes are exactly the arithmetic indices not divisible by ab . This gives a concrete product homeomorphism rather than only a finite-rank count.

The arbitrary finite-shape theorem adds the missing local organization. Selected coordinates become edges of root-wise bipartite graphs, allowed labels are vertex-potential coboundaries, and graph cycles are the complete compatibility obstruction. As a result, the coordinate matroid is graphic and normalized Haar dependence is exact: forests give joint independence, while each cycle-rank unit contributes $\log q$ of total correlation. The pairwise-independent but plaquette-dependent four-corner example is the smallest instance of this rule.

Arithmetic prefixes and exponent rectangles are therefore not isolated formulas. The former have

$$q^{L - \lfloor L/(ab) \rfloor}$$

patterns because they retain a positive density of free axes. The latter have q^{M+N-1} patterns because a complete exponent box uses only $M + N - 1$ independent vertex potentials. Both follow from the same finite-shape rank, but their normalizations describe different geometries. A separate choice of action and averaging sequence is required before either calculation can be promoted to a dynamical entropy statement.

The manuscript makes no priority claim. Its proof package is closed at the internal-draft level, while external release remains contingent on specialist exact-neighbor review in multiplicative symbolic dynamics, algebraic actions, finite-field coding, and matroidal probability.

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